

DELAYED GRATIFICATION

A CLUTCH OF START-UPS HAS TURNED THE CONCEPT OF BUY NOW, PAY LATER ON ITS HEAD TO DEVISE SAVE NOW, BUY LATER SCHEMES THAT INCENTIVISE SAVING FOR BIG SPENDS WHILE AVOIDING THE DEBT TRAP THAT COMES WITH BNPL. AND THERE ARE MANY TAKERS

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INCLINED AS WE humans are towards rewards and discounts, we find it incredibly difficult to ignore a good incentive or a great deal. It doesn't matter where one lives or which strata of society one belongs to, everyone loves a discount or cashback when making a purchase, big or small.

Dinesh Ladi, a 28-year-old data scientist in Bengaluru, is no different. Wanting to buy an iPhone 13, he was looking around for some deals when he came across a platform that offered him a 10 per cent 'cash reward' for the buy, with just one catch: he had to save a fixed amount of money for a few months. The added incentive was that there was no interest component or processing fee. Simply put, it was not a debt or credit scheme like Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL). "Earlier, I used to keep money in a separate account to save for a purchase. There are fixed deposit options as well but you don't get any incentive on the price if you go by these routes," Ladi says, adding that he thought of trying out the novel method because the start-up offered a cash reward as well.

